

"Test Automation Reduces Quality Assurance Lifecycle By At Least 50 Per Cent"

► The digital age demands seamless, uninterrupted experience—be it over a website, a mobile application or any software service. Major industries like banks and e-commerce rely heavily on software platforms to reach out to their customers. Maneesh Jhawar, founder and CEO, and Gauraav Thakar, VP and head of marketing, QualityKiosk Technologies, speak to EFY about the importance of software quality assurance and the impact of test automation for businesses

Q. How does quality assurance improve business for product developers?

A. Customer experience with a brand needs to be seamless. Quality has become sacrosanct. A mobile app or a website cannot be launched as long as it performs the way it was intended.

Enterprise-class customers do not use just one system but a complete ecosystem to get their business output. Pre-production quality assurance saves businesses substantial expenses on rework. The faster they catch a bug in the system, the quicker



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they can solve it with minimal faulty outcomes. Quality assurance is done not just at the code level but at the system architecture level.

If quality assurance is not done properly, the defect might be found to have multiplied during user acceptance testing, and that will lead to massive rework. At times, if the bug reaches post-production stage, it has a direct impact on the business in terms of brand image as well as loss of finances. Quality assurance partners help developers not just by saying "there is a bug in your system" but also by pointing out where the bug is and what is causing it. This greatly reduces time, effort and financial expenses in solving defects.

Q. What makes a good-quality software?

A. You should take into account the expected functionality of the software and whether it will be a standalone application or a piece of a larger IT ecosystem. Every functionality of the application should work exactly the way it is intended to. Another aspect is the performance. To create reputation, customer experience has to be equal or higher than what they are expecting.

Q. What are the most essential technical components of quality assurance?

A. The first component is functional testing. Test automation is the key towards decreasing the software development lifecycle (SDLC). Performance engineering is the second essential parameter. It drives the root-cause analysis of issues and perfor-

mance enhancement. Finally, digital testing, like mobile applications testing, is also important for usability and compatibility.

Testing models decide the route of progress. Waterfall model has been a tried-and-tested process for a long time. But with digital transformation, Agile model has taken up

the market. DevOps is becoming a major contributor in the preproduction phase. Customer experience testing is a major post-production technology.

Q. Will Internet of Things (IoT) applications change the quality assurance paradigm?

A. Let us revisit an old fundamental of IT applications—garbage-in and garbage-out. When we come to the IoT, this rule becomes dominant. Quality assurance will be around the Big Data that the IoT systems generate daily. In IoT software, the most important checkpoint will be to analyse whether the correct data is being sent in the business scenarios. These will correlate to the test scenarios. The necessary data will have to be filtered, while the rest should be dumped.

Another unique thing will be predictive analytics. Quality assurance will ensure proper interaction and proper machine data flow. In this way, it will drive how predictive analysis comes out from IoT systems.

Q. Can quality assurance add to security applications, especially in data-sensitive zones?

A. Well, quality providers integrate security measures to their offerings. For instance, we at QualityKiosk ensure that while providing services to our clients, we embed the latest and the most upgraded security measures into solutions. We do not deal directly in creating security suites. Rather, we collaborate with ecosystem partners and experts to deliver security. **EFY**